# Sisi: platform overview

*PPS Investments SDG Challenge entry. Prototype status: a working, fully client-side mock with simulated rewards and simulated community members. Education, not financial advice.*

## 1. The bigger picture

**The problem.** Many young South African women start their financial lives without the knowledge, confidence or say over money they need, and most financial products are not designed around them. That limits what they can learn, save and decide.

**What Sisi is.** A friendly, "smart older sister" money-learning companion. It teaches a little at a time, makes practising feel safe, rewards showing up (never punishes a missed day), and surrounds learners with a community. It never asks for income, ID numbers or account numbers.

**The goals we serve.**

- **SDG 4, Quality Education (primary):** financial literacy and numeracy (4.6), practical skills (4.4), equal access (4.5). Delivered through short lessons with quizzes, practice tools and coaching.
- **SDG 5, Gender Equality (primary):** women's access to economic resources and financial services (5.a), technology that enables (5.b), and a safe space designed for women. Delivered through women-centred content, community and Money Buddy, and confidence-building.
- **SDG 10, Reduced Inequalities (byproduct):** we report results by age, situation and barriers (data cost, language, shared phone) to show whether Sisi reaches women who are usually left out. There are no separate features for it.

**How it fits PPS.** Learn, practise, save, then invest. Sisi builds the habit and confidence first; any move toward real PPS products is a later, regulated step that PPS would own.

## 2. Features built (all working in the prototype)

| Pillar | What exists today | Serves |
|---|---|---|
| **Learn** | Courses with six-card lessons, quizzes with explanations and a small action: "Money Matters" (7 lessons, from PPS financial-literacy material) and an O-Week Starter course (3 lessons) | SDG 4 |
| **Practise** | Budget tool with templates and live coaching; payslip decoder (gross to net, tax, allocate every rand); guided investing step (Invest HER) | SDG 4, 5 |
| **Progress** | Bloom (grows as you learn), points, badges, levels, a weekly target of 1 to 3 days (no streaks that break), focus mode that hides points | SDG 4 |
| **Rewards** | Reward ladder, choice of cash or investment credit (credit is worth 10% more), claim tracking (Claimed, Approved, Paid) and a weekly prize draw. All simulated and subject to PPS approval | SDG 5.a |
| **Connect** | Campus and interest communities with a Lounge, Circles, Money Buddy (weekly plan, nudges), friends and a Letterbox of shared wins (never amounts), events with QR tickets, invite links, an O-Week QR poster | SDG 5 |
| **Safety and help** | Talk to someone, Support page and FAQ, a Quick exit button, no tracking on the support page, privacy by design | SDG 5 |
| **Staff console** | Pages to review claims, help requests, safety reports, generate the poster and view pilot results | Operations |
| **Experience** | Mobile-first, collapsible navigation, Fraunces and Plus Jakarta Sans with the Bloom logo, notifications and reminders | All |

## 3. The pilot (built and ready)

- **Guided story of about 18 minutes** with Sisi as the guide: Learn (lesson and quiz), Do (coached budget, payslip decoder), Progress, Reward (simulated claim), Connect (join a practice community, say hello, meet a Money

Buddy).

- **Evidence:** the app records only what testers did (finished steps, timings, quiz score, choices), anonymously, with no names, amounts or message text. One 20-question multiple-choice Google Form covers experience, likes and dislikes, ease, understanding, confidence and barriers, mapped to SDG 4 and 5. Testers link the two with a 4-character participant ID.
- **Materials:** tester guide PDF with QR code, facilitator guide, decision rules (for example 80% finish, 70% quiz pass), a results dashboard and CSV export.
- **Honest limits:** the community and buddy are simulated; there is no follow-up survey, so saving and say-over-money answers are a baseline snapshot, not a measured change.

## 4. What we want next

| Horizon | Item | Why |
|---|---|---|
| **Right after the pilot** | Apply findings; review the verdicts against the decision rules; fix what testers struggled with | Evidence-led improvement |
| | Load PPS's final lesson content and review figures (TFSA limits, tax tables) with PPS | Accuracy and approval |
| **Next build** | Real accounts and a backend (today everything lives in the browser) | Persistence, multi-device, real evidence at scale |
| | Real community moderation and safe chat (image upload, reporting, staff tools) | Real peer support |
| | Push reminders, installable web app, more languages (for example isiZulu, isiXhosa, Afrikaans) | Reach and retention, SDG 10 |
| | Fuller staff console, reels and short-video lessons, more courses | Operations and engagement |
| **With PPS** | Real reward fulfilment and investment onboarding (regulated; PPS owns compliance, POPIA and FSCA) | Turns learning into real saving and investing |
| | Automated smoke tests and a demo script | Reliability |

## 5. Principles that stay fixed

Education, not advice. Simulations always labelled. No income, ID or account numbers requested. Rewards that people choose, never pressure. Anonymous evidence, POPIA-aware. Women-centred, safe by default.

## 6. Decisions we still need from the team

Final SDG targets and decision-rule thresholds; PPS-approved consent and POPIA wording; reward funding and who fulfils claims; whether to add a post-pilot follow-up later.